

4.11

Problems, problems

Worksheet

Form small groups to have a discussion. Follow this sequence:

- 1 One person choose a problem from the list and explain it in your own words to the others.
- 2 Everyone think of possible solutions to the problem. Choose the best solution.
- 3 Repeat for the other people in the group.

Making suggestions

How about ... (+ *-ing*)?

Why not ... ?

It's just an idea, but why don't you ...?

Have you ever thought of ... (+ *-ing*)

I know, maybe you could ...

Agreeing

That sounds like a good idea.

That might be worth trying.

Yes, I think that would work really well
because...

Disagreeing

I'm not sure about that because ...

Don't you think a better alternative
would be ... ?

I'm afraid I don't really like that idea.

- 1 You've been feeling very tired recently, although at bedtime you can't get to sleep. You seem to have little energy for doing anything at the moment.
- 2 You have a debt of \$3000 on your VISA card. You don't have much cash at the moment.
- 3 You feel that you are a little overweight. You have tried dieting and exercise many times but each time you give up after a few weeks.
- 4 Your son has recently been caught trying to break into a car and steal the radio. You can't understand it as he is normally so well-behaved. He refuses to talk about it.
- 5 A friend of yours has just lost her job at the age of 50 due to reorganization in her company. She was a Marketing Manager, and was successful in her work. She has applied for many jobs but never even gets an answer.
- 6 You have invited your boss for dinner at your house tonight and have prepared a beautiful meat dish. Suddenly you remember that your boss is vegetarian. He/She is due to arrive in 45 minutes. What dish can you prepare to impress him/her?
- 7 You've got to buy a present for your retired aunt. You don't have much money or much time to go looking.
- 8 Your mother-in-law lives in the same block. She often visits and usually finds something to criticize.
- 9 Your job is boring, badly paid and you don't really like your colleagues. Unfortunately new jobs are hard to find these days.
- 10 You want to improve your English but you have very little time and it is impossible to attend regular classes.

